

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

During the third pregnancy she was told to go to bed and rest from the third month on. She carried the baby full-term and delivered without any major problems. However, shortly after the baby was born, Paula was diagnosed with leukemia. While she was undergoing therapy, John lost his job when the company he worked for shut down. The bills piled up, both personal and medical, until their lives became strained to the breaking point.

When they came to see me, they owed over \$40,000 in personal bills. The utility company was threatening to shut off their power, the phone was disconnected, and they were two months behind in rent.

After reviewing their situation, I could see no way to resolve their financial problems. An attorney for their creditors had suggested that they file for bankruptcy because it was apparent they would never be able to pay their bills. My question to John and Paula was the same one that God asks each of us: "Do you trust God?" It's easy to SAY you trust God when things are going well, but the bottom line is, do you REALLY trust God? As Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego said, "Our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the furnace of blazing fire; and He will deliver us out of your hand, O king. But even if He does not, let it be known to you, O king, that we are not going to serve your gods or worship the golden image that you have set up" (Daniel 3:17-18). Can you still trust God, even though you can see no logical way out?

John and Paula said they did trust God and knew inside that they should not go bankrupt. They left with a commitment to take their needs back to their church and ask for the church's help.

In the meantime, I mentioned their need at a weekly men's Bible study I taught. One of the men at our Bible study knew of another Christian who was looking for an employee with John's qualifications. It turned out that John was an answer to his very specific prayers for a loyal, hard working Christian to help in his business. In addition, two of our group took on the task of raising some of the needed funds to clear the immedi-